

IELTS 2026

FORECAST



MATERIAL

BỘ CÂU HỎI BÀI TẬP FORECAST 2026

IELTS SPEAKING INTENSIVE



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Lời nói đầu

Nhằm mục đích hỗ trợ các học viên trong việc chuẩn bị cho kỳ thi IELTS, **The Forum Center** đã ra mắt dự án *IELTS Speaking Forecast Intensive*.

Tài liệu này tập trung vào việc tổng hợp và giải chi tiết các câu hỏi dự đoán (Forecast) bám sát xu hướng đề thi thực tế mới nhất, bao gồm:

- **Part 1:** Các chủ đề xoay quanh cuộc sống thường ngày.
- **Part 2:** Các dạng bài mô tả trọng tâm (Cue Cards) rèn luyện phát triển ý tưởng trong 2 phút.
- **Part 3:** Các câu hỏi nghị luận xã hội đòi hỏi tư duy sâu sắc và cách trả lời logic.

Mỗi chủ đề đều được thiết kế với dàn ý rõ ràng, cung cấp ý tưởng mở rộng, từ vựng ăn điểm và bài mẫu mang tính ứng dụng cao.

Chúc các bạn ôn tập hiệu quả và chinh phục thành công mục tiêu IELTS!

Hướng dẫn sử dụng

Cách tiếp cận bài học

1. **Lên ý tưởng:** Tự phác thảo ý chính dựa trên câu hỏi trước khi tham khảo câu trả lời mẫu.
2. **Đọc hiểu & Phân tích:** Nghiên cứu các cụm từ (collocations) và cách tổ chức ý trong bài giải.
3. **Thực hành phát âm:** Đọc thành tiếng các câu trả lời, chú ý đến các ngắt nghỉ, nhấn nhá đã được gợi ý.
4. **Cá nhân hoá:** Áp dụng từ vựng để tạo câu trả lời của riêng mình.

Chương 1

Part 1: Personal & General Topics

PART 1: PERSONAL & LIFESTYLE TOPICS

1.1 Work or Studies

What work do you do?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Well, I'm currently a third-year university student majoring in Business Administration. Most of my time is taken up by attending lectures and working on group assignments. I haven't started a formal job yet, but I occasionally do freelance graphic design on the side to earn some pocket money and build up my portfolio.

What subjects are you studying?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I'm taking a range of subjects like marketing, corporate finance, and microeconomics. To be honest, marketing is hands down my favourite because it lets me unleash my creativity rather than just crunching numbers all day long.

Do you like your subject?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Absolutely! Even though the workload can be quite overwhelming at times, I find most of my subjects genuinely practical. Learning the ropes of how real businesses operate gives me a solid foundation for my future career aspirations, so it feels very rewarding in the long run.

Why did you choose to study that subject?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Well, to be honest, I've always been fascinated by how companies market their products and influence consumer behaviour. On top of that, my older sister runs a small online business, and watching her sparked my interest in understanding the business world from the inside.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
major in	v phr	/ˈmeɪ.dʒər ɪn/	to study as a main subject	học chuyên ngành
take up	phr v	/teɪk ʌp/	to occupy (time or space)	chiếm (thời gian)
freelance	adj	/ˈfriː.lɑːns/	working independently, not for one employer	làm nghề tự do
portfolio	n	/pɔːtˈfəʊ.li.əʊ/	a collection of work samples	hồ sơ năng lực
hands down	adv	/hændz daʊn/	without doubt, easily	chắc chắn, không bàn cãi
crunch numbers	v phr	/krʌntʃ ˈnʌm.bərz/	to process numerical data	xử lý số liệu
learn the ropes	idiom	/lɜːn ðə rəʊps/	to learn how things work	học cách làm việc
solid foundation	n phr	/ˈsɒl.ɪd faʊnˈdeɪ.ʃən/	a strong base of knowledge	nền tảng vững chắc
spark one's interest	v phr	/spɑːk wʌnz ˈɪn.trəst/	to arouse curiosity	khơi dậy sự hứng thú
consumer behaviour	n phr	/kənˈsjʊː.mər bɪˈheɪ.vjər/	how people buy things	hành vi người tiêu dùng

1.2 Hometown

Where is your hometown?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

My hometown is Da Nang, a coastal city in central Vietnam. It's become increasingly popular as a tourist destination over the past decade, thanks to its stunning beaches and the iconic Dragon Bridge. I'm really proud to be from there, actually.

Do you like your hometown?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Oh, definitely! There's a lot to love about Da Nang. The pace of life is much more laid-back compared to big cities like Ho Chi Minh City, and you can literally walk to the beach in ten minutes from almost anywhere downtown. It really strikes a great balance between modern development and natural beauty.

What do you like most about your hometown?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I think what I cherish most is the food culture. Da Nang is famous for dishes like Mi Quang and Banh Xeo, and you can find incredible street food stalls on practically every corner. The local cuisine is not only delicious but also really affordable, which is a huge plus for a student like me.

Is there anything you dislike about it?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

If I had to pick something, I'd say the weather can be pretty extreme. During the rainy season from October to December, the city often gets hit by severe flooding, which disrupts daily life quite a bit. But apart from that, I honestly can't complain much.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
coastal	adj	/ˈkəʊs.təl/	near or along the coast	thuộc vùng ven biển
stunning	adj	/ˈstʌn.ɪŋ/	extremely beautiful	tuyệt đẹp, lộng lẫy
iconic	adj	/aɪˈkɒn.ɪk/	widely recognised and well-known	mang tính biểu tượng
laid-back	adj	/ˌleɪdˈbæk/	relaxed and unhurried	thư thả, thoải mái
strike a balance	v phr	/straɪk ə ˈbæl.əns/	to find a compromise	đạt được sự cân bằng
cherish	v	/ˈtʃer.ɪʃ/	to value something highly	trân trọng
local cuisine	n phr	/ˈləʊ.kəl kwiˈziːn/	food typical of a region	ẩm thực địa phương
affordable	adj	/əˈfɔː.də.bəl/	reasonably priced	giá cả phải chăng
severe flooding	n phr	/sɪˈvɪər ˈflʌd.ɪŋ/	serious overflow of water	lũ lụt nghiêm trọng
disrupt	v	/dɪsˈrʌpt/	to interrupt or disturb	gây gián đoạn

1.3 Home and Accommodation

Do you live in an apartment or a house?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Right now I'm renting a small apartment near my university campus. It's nothing fancy — just a studio with a tiny kitchen — but it's cosy enough for one person. The best part is that it's within walking distance of the campus, so I save quite a bit on transportation.

What part of your home do you like the most?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I'd have to say my desk area by the window. It overlooks a small garden, which is very calming when I'm studying or doing assignments late at night. I've set it up with a reading lamp and some potted plants, so it feels like my own little productive corner.

Do you plan to live there for a long time?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Probably not, to be honest. Once I graduate, I'm planning to relocate to a bigger city like Ho Chi Minh City to pursue better career opportunities. But for the time being, this place serves its purpose perfectly well and the rent is within my budget, so I'm pretty content.

What kind of house or apartment do you want to live in in the future?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Ideally, I'd love to own a modern apartment with a balcony in the city centre, somewhere with plenty of natural light and enough space for a proper home office. I think having a dedicated workspace at home is becoming essential, especially with the rise of remote working.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
rent	v	/rent/	to pay to use something temporarily	thuê
cosy	adj	/'kəʊ.zi/	warm, comfortable, and welcoming	ấm cúng
within walking distance	adv phr	/wɪ'ðɪn 'wɔː.kɪŋ 'dɪs.təns/	close enough to walk	trong khoảng cách đi bộ
overlook	v	/,əʊ.və'lʊk/	to have a view of from above	nhìn ra
relocate	v	/,riː.ləʊ'keɪt/	to move to a new place	chuyển chỗ ở
for the time being	adv phr	/fɔːr ðə taɪm 'biːɪŋ/	for now, temporarily	hiện tại, tạm thời
serve its purpose	v phr	/sɜːv ɪts 'pɜː.pəs/	to fulfil its intended function	đáp ứng mục đích
dedicated	adj	/'ded.ɪ.keɪ.tɪd/	designed for a particular purpose	chuyên dụng
remote working	n phr	/rɪ'məʊt 'wɜː.kɪŋ/	working from home or outside office	làm việc từ xa
natural light	n phr	/'nætʃ.əl laɪt/	sunlight coming into a room	ánh sáng tự nhiên

PART 1: DAILY LIFE & HABITS

1.4 Morning Time

Do you like getting up early in the morning?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Honestly, I'm not really a morning person. I tend to stay up late studying or scrolling through social media, so waking up early feels like a real struggle. But on the days when I do manage to get up early, I notice that I'm far more productive throughout the day, so I'm trying to make it a habit.

What do you usually do in the morning?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

It depends on the day, really. On weekdays, I usually wake up, brush my teeth, and have a quick breakfast — normally just some bread and coffee — before heading to my first lecture. On weekends, though, I give myself the luxury of sleeping in and then maybe going for a walk around the neighbourhood.

Is the morning time important to you?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Yes, I think it is, even though I'm not great at utilising it. Studies show that mornings are when our brains are freshest, so it makes sense to tackle the most challenging tasks during that time. I've noticed that when I have a structured morning routine, the rest of my day tends to go much more smoothly.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
morning person	n phr	/ˈmɔː.nɪŋ ˈpɜː.sən/	someone who feels best in the morning	người thích dậy sớm
stay up late	phr v	/steɪ ʌp leɪt/	to go to bed later than usual	thức khuya
scroll through	phr v	/skrɔʊl θruː/	to browse content on a screen	lướt xem (mạng xã hội)
make it a habit	v phr	/meɪk ɪt ə ˈhæb.ɪt/	to do something regularly	tạo thói quen
head to	phr v	/hed tuː/	to go towards a place	đi đến
sleep in	phr v	/sliːp ɪn/	to sleep later than usual	ngủ nướng
utilise	v	/ˈjuː.tɪ.laɪz/	to make practical use of	tận dụng
tackle	v	/ˈtæk.əl/	to deal with or address	giải quyết
structured	adj	/ˈstrʌk.tʃəd/	well-organised and planned	có cấu trúc, có kế hoạch

1.5 Spare Time

What do you usually do in your spare time?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

In my spare time, I'm really into watching YouTube tutorials about digital design — it ties in nicely with my graphic design side hustle. Apart from that, I enjoy hanging out with my friends at local cafés or binge-watching Korean dramas when I need to unwind after a long week.

Do you think you have enough spare time?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Not really, to be honest. Between attending classes, studying for exams, and doing my freelance work, there isn't much time left over. I sometimes feel like I'm juggling too many things at once, which can be quite draining. But I think that's pretty typical for university students these days.

Has the way you spend your free time changed since you were young?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Definitely. When I was a kid, I used to spend most of my free time playing outdoors with friends, like riding bicycles or playing hide and seek. Now, my leisure time is much more screen-based — whether it's watching videos, browsing social media, or working on design projects. I suppose that's just part of growing up in the digital age.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
be into	phr v	/bi: 'ɪn.tu:/	to be very interested in	thích, đam mê
side hustle	n phr	/saɪd 'hʌs.əl/	a secondary job for extra income	công việc phụ
hang out	phr v	/hæŋ aʊt/	to spend time socialising	đi chơi, la cà
binge-watch	v	/bɪndʒ wɒtʃ/	to watch many episodes in a row	xem liền một mạch
unwind	v	/ʌn'waɪnd/	to relax after stress	thư giãn
juggle	v	/'dʒʌg.əl/	to manage multiple tasks	xoay xở nhiều việc
draining	adj	/'dreɪ.nɪŋ/	making you feel exhausted	mệt mỏi, kiệt sức
leisure time	n phr	/'leɪ.ər taɪm/	time free from work or duties	thời gian giải trí
digital age	n phr	/'dɪdʒ.ɪ.təl eɪdʒ/	the modern era of technology	kỷ nguyên số

1.6 Day Off

When is your day off?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I usually have Sundays completely free because my university doesn't schedule any classes that day. Saturdays are hit or miss though — sometimes I have group project meetings or need to catch up on assignments. So Sunday is the one day I can truly relax without feeling guilty.

What do you usually do on your day off?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I usually start the day by sleeping in until around nine or ten, then I'll grab brunch with a couple of friends at a nearby café. In the afternoon, I might browse some bookshops or just chill at home watching Netflix. I try to make the most of it because weekdays are always packed with deadlines.

Do you think it is important to have days off?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Oh, absolutely. I think days off are essential for both mental and physical well-being. Without them, people would burn out very quickly. Having time to recharge helps you come back to your work or studies feeling refreshed and more focused. It's really a matter of balance — all work and no play is simply not sustainable.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
hit or miss	adj phr	/hɪt ɔːr mɪs/	unpredictable, inconsistent	không chắc chắn
catch up on	phr v	/kætʃ ʌp ɒn/	to complete something you missed	bắt kịp, hoàn thành
feel guilty	v phr	/fiːl 'ɡɪl.ti/	to feel bad about something	cảm thấy áy náy
grab brunch	v phr	/græb brʌntʃ/	to have a late morning meal	ăn brunch
make the most of	v phr	/meɪk ðə məʊst ɒv/	to use something to best advantage	tận dụng tối đa
packed with	adj phr	/pækt wɪð/	full of	chật kín
burn out	phr v	/bɜːn aʊt/	to become exhausted from overwork	kiệt sức
recharge	v	/ˌriːtʃɑːdʒ/	to regain energy	nạp lại năng lượng
sustainable	adj	/sə'steɪ.nə.bəl/	able to be maintained long-term	bền vững

1.7 Having a Break

Do you usually take a break during work or study?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Oh yes, absolutely. I find that taking short breaks every hour or so helps me stay focused and avoid burnout. I usually get up, stretch a bit, or grab a cup of coffee. If I push through for too long without stopping, my concentration drops significantly and I end up making careless mistakes.

What do you usually do during a break?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

It varies. Sometimes I just scroll through some memes on my phone or chat with classmates about random stuff. Other times, I'll step outside for some fresh air, especially if I've been cramming for an exam. I think even a five-minute change of scenery can do wonders for your productivity.

Do you think breaks are important?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Without a doubt. There's actually scientific evidence suggesting that regular breaks boost cognitive function and creativity. The Pomodoro Technique, for example, recommends working in 25-minute intervals followed by short breaks, and many people swear by it. I think the key is finding a rhythm that works for you personally.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
stay focused	v phr	/steɪ 'fəʊ.kəst/	to maintain concentration	giữ tập trung
burnout	n	/'bɜːn.aʊt/	extreme exhaustion from overwork	kiệt sức
push through	phr v	/pʊʃ θruː/	to force oneself to continue	cố gắng vượt qua
concentration	n	/ˌkɒn.sən'treɪ.ʃən/	the ability to focus	sự tập trung
careless mistake	n phr	/'keə.ləs mɪ'steɪk/	an error due to inattention	lỗi bất cẩn
cram for an exam	v phr	/kræm fɔːr ən ɪɡ'zæm/	to study intensely before a test	ôn thi gấp
change of scenery	n phr	/tʃeɪndʒ ɒv 'siː.nər.i/	a different environment	đổi không gian
cognitive function	n phr	/'kɒɡ.nɪ.tɪv 'fʌŋk.ʃən/	mental processes like thinking	chức năng nhận thức
swear by	phr v	/sweər baɪ/	to strongly believe in something	tin tưởng tuyệt đối

1.8 Going Out

How often do you go out?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I'd say about two or three times a week, usually in the evenings after finishing my classes. I mostly go out to grab dinner with friends or visit a café to study in a different environment. On special occasions, like someone's birthday, we might go to a karaoke place or a rooftop bar, but that's not a regular thing.

Where do you usually go when you go out?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I'm a huge fan of cosy little cafés, so most of my outings revolve around those. There's a place near my university called The Coffee House that I particularly love because it has good Wi-Fi and a peaceful atmosphere for studying. Apart from cafés, I also enjoy exploring night markets when I want something more lively and social.

Do you prefer going out alone or with friends?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

It really depends on my mood. When I need some quiet time to recharge or think things over, I prefer going out alone — maybe a solo walk along the river or a visit to a bookstore. But most of the time, I enjoy company because socialising energises me and makes everyday activities like eating out much more enjoyable.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
special occasion	n phr	/ˈspeʃ.əl əˈkeɪ.ʒən/	an important event or celebration	dịp đặc biệt
rooftop bar	n phr	/ˈruːf.tɒp bɑːr/	a bar on top of a building	quán bar trên sân thượng
outing	n	/ˈaʊ.tɪŋ/	a short trip or excursion	chuyến đi chơi
revolve around	phr v	/rɪˈvɒlv əˈraʊnd/	to centre on or focus on	xoay quanh
atmosphere	n	/ˈæt.mə.sfiər/	the mood or feeling of a place	bầu không khí
night market	n phr	/naɪt ˈmɑː.kɪt/	an outdoor market active in the evening	chợ đêm
lively	adj	/ˈlaɪv.li/	full of energy and activity	sôi động
recharge	v	/ˌriːˈtʃɑːdʒ/	to rest and regain energy	nạp lại năng lượng
socialise	v	/ˈsəʊ.ʃəl.aɪz/	to interact with others	giao lưu

1.9 Walking

Do you walk a lot?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Yes, quite a lot actually. Since my apartment is close to the university, I walk to campus almost every day. It takes about fifteen minutes, which I find is a nice opportunity to clear my head before classes. I also walk around the neighbourhood after dinner sometimes, just to get some exercise and fresh air.

Where did you go for a walk lately?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Just last weekend, I went for a long walk along the Han River waterfront. The weather was perfect — not too hot, with a nice breeze — so I put on my earphones and just strolled along for about an hour. It was incredibly relaxing and a great way to decompress after a stressful week of exams.

Why do people like to walk in parks?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I think it's because parks offer a peaceful escape from the hustle and bustle of city life. Being surrounded by greenery and hearing birds singing can be really therapeutic. For many people, walking in parks is also a social activity — they go with family or friends, or even join outdoor exercise groups. It's basically a free, accessible way to improve both physical and mental well-being.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
clear one's head	v phr	/klɪər wʌnz hed/	to stop worrying and think clearly	làm thông thoáng đầu óc
stroll	v	/streʊl/	to walk slowly and casually	đi dạo thong thả
decompress	v	/ˌdiː.kəmˈpres/	to relax and relieve stress	giải tỏa căng thẳng
hustle and bustle	n phr	/ˈhʌs.əl ænd ˈbʌs.əl/	busy, noisy activity	sự nhộn nhịp, hối hả
greenery	n	/ˈɡriː.nər.i/	green plants and vegetation	cây cối xanh tươi
therapeutic	adj	/ˌθer.əˈpiː.tɪk/	having a healing or calming effect	có tính trị liệu
accessible	adj	/əkˈses.ə.bəl/	easy to reach or use	dễ tiếp cận
well-being	n	/ˌwelˈbiː.ɪŋ/	the state of being healthy and happy	sự khỏe mạnh, hạnh phúc

PART 1: PERSONAL PREFERENCES & ACTIVITIES

1.10 Hobby

Do you have any hobbies?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Yes, I do! My main hobby is digital illustration — I love creating artwork on my tablet using apps like Procreate. I picked it up about two years ago and I've been hooked ever since. It's become more than just a hobby, actually, because I sometimes take on small freelance projects through it.

Did you have any hobbies when you were a child?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Oh, for sure. When I was younger, I was really into building model kits — you know, those little plastic aeroplane and car models that you assemble piece by piece. I could spend hours meticulously gluing parts together and painting them. It taught me patience and attention to detail, which I think still benefit me today.

Do you have a hobby that you've had since childhood?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Come to think of it, drawing is something I've always enjoyed, even from a very young age. Of course, my style has evolved enormously — from colourful crayon doodles to digital art — but the core passion for visual creativity has remained constant throughout my life.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
digital illustration	n phr	/ˈdɪdʒ.ɪ.təl ˌɪl.əˈstreɪ.ʃən/	creating artwork on a computer or tablet	vẽ minh họa kỹ thuật số
pick up	phr v	/pɪk ʌp/	to learn a new skill informally	học, tập
hooked	adj	/hʊkt/	very interested or addicted	bị cuốn hút
model kit	n phr	/ˈmɒd.əl kɪt/	a set of parts to assemble a miniature	bộ mô hình lắp ráp
meticulously	adv	/mɪˈtɪk.jə.ləs.li/	with great care and precision	một cách tỉ mỉ
attention to detail	n phr	/əˈten.ʃən tuː ˈdiː.teɪl/	careful focus on small parts	sự chú ý đến chi tiết
evolve	v	/ɪˈvɒlʃ/	to develop gradually	phát triển, tiến hóa
doodle	n	/ˈduː.dəl/	a casual, rough drawing	nét vẽ nguệch ngoạc
constant	adj	/ˈkɒn.stənt/	remaining the same, unchanging	không đổi

Chương 2

Part 2 & 3: Cue Cards & Discussion Topics

2.1 Describe a city you enjoyed visiting

IELTS Part 2 — Cue Card

Describe a city you enjoyed visiting. You should say:

- Where it is
- When you visited it
- How long you stayed there
- What you did there
- And explain why you enjoyed visiting it.

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Well, off the top of my head, I'd love to talk about my trip to Hoi An, a charming ancient town in central Vietnam. I visited there last summer with a couple of close friends right after our final exams, and we ended up staying for about five days.

To be honest, I was absolutely blown away by the atmosphere. The old town is lined with beautiful yellow-walled houses, colourful lanterns hanging everywhere, and narrow cobblestone streets that make you feel like you've stepped back in time. During the day, we wandered around the Japanese Covered Bridge and visited some local tailor shops — Hoi An is famous for its custom-made clothing. In the evenings, we'd sit by the Thu Bon River, release paper lanterns, and just soak in the peaceful vibes.

What really made the trip special was the food. We tried Cao Lau, a noodle dish unique to Hoi An, and I must say it was out of this world. The combination of chewy noodles, crispy pork, and fresh herbs was simply unforgettable.

Come to think of it, the reason I enjoyed Hoi An so much was that it offered the perfect blend of culture, history, and relaxation. It wasn't overcrowded like some other tourist spots, and the locals were incredibly warm and welcoming. I'd go back there in a heartbeat.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
charming	adj	/ˈtʃɑː.mɪŋ/	pleasantly attractive	quyến rũ, duyên dáng
blown away	adj phr	/bləʊn əˈweɪ/	very impressed	ấn tượng mạnh
cobblestone	n	/ˈkɒb.əl.stəʊn/	rounded stones used for paving	đá cuội lát đường
custom-made	adj	/ˈkʌs.təm meɪd/	made to individual specifications	may đo riêng
soak in	phr v	/səʊk ɪn/	to enjoy and absorb an experience	tận hưởng, đắm mình
out of this world	idiom	/aʊt ɒv ðɪs wɜːld/	exceptionally good	tuyệt vời
unforgettable	adj	/ˌʌn.fəˈget.ə.bəl/	impossible to forget	không thể quên
blend	n	/blend/	a mixture or combination	sự pha trộn
in a heartbeat	idiom	/ɪn ə ˈhɑːt.biːt/	immediately, without hesitation	ngay lập tức
overcrowded	adj	/ˌəʊ.vəˈkraʊ.dɪd/	filled with too many people	quá đông đúc

Part 3 — Discussion Questions

1. What kinds of facilities do big cities have?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Big cities typically offer a wide range of public facilities such as modern hospitals, well-equipped schools, shopping malls, and efficient public transport systems like metros. On top of that, you'd find entertainment venues like cinemas, parks, and sports complexes. These are the things that really set major cities apart from smaller towns.

2. Do you think modern cities are suitable for young people or old people?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I'd say modern cities tend to be more tailored to young people because they offer more job opportunities, vibrant social scenes, and faster-paced lifestyles. That said, older people might struggle with the noise, pollution, and high cost of living. However, some cities are making efforts to become more elderly-friendly by improving healthcare services and creating

more green spaces.

3. Before you travel to a city, what factors would you consider?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

There are quite a few things I'd look into. First and foremost, I'd check the weather forecast so I can pack appropriately. I'd also research local attractions, accommodation options, and the food scene. As a student, budget is always a key concern, so I'd compare prices for flights and hostels beforehand. Safety is another important factor — I always check travel advisories.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
facility	n	/fə'sɪl.ə.ti/	a building or service for a purpose	cơ sở vật chất
well-equipped	adj	/wel r'kwɪpt/	having all necessary tools or features	được trang bị tốt
set apart	phr v	/set ə'pɑ:t/	to distinguish from others	phân biệt, nổi bật hơn
tailored to	adj phr	/'teɪ.ləd tu:/	designed to suit someone	phù hợp cho
vibrant	adj	/'vaɪ.brənt/	full of energy and life	sôi động
cost of living	n phr	/kɒst ɒv 'lɪv.ɪŋ/	the price of basic necessities	chi phí sinh hoạt
elderly-friendly	adj	/'el.dəl.i 'frend.li/	suitable for older people	thân thiện với người cao tuổi
first and foremost	adv phr	/fɜːst ænd 'fɔː.məʊst/	most importantly	trước hết
travel advisory	n phr	/'træv.əl əd'vaɪ.zər.i/	official travel safety notices	khuyến cáo du lịch

2.2 Describe a person who likes to look after the natural world

IELTS Part 2 — Cue Card

Describe a person who likes to look after the natural world. You should say:

- Who this person is
- What he or she does
- How he or she does it
- And explain how you feel about this person.

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I'd like to talk about my biology teacher, Ms. Lan, who is genuinely passionate about protecting the environment. She's been teaching at my school for over ten years, and what sets her apart is her hands-on approach to environmental education.

She doesn't just talk about sustainability in the classroom — she actually practises what she preaches. Every month, she organises beach clean-up campaigns where she takes students to nearby coastal areas to collect plastic waste and raise awareness about marine pollution. She also maintains a community garden at the school where students learn to grow organic vegetables without using harmful pesticides.

What I admire most is her consistency. Rain or shine, she never misses a single clean-up event. She even spends her weekends volunteering at a local wildlife rescue centre, helping to rehabilitate injured birds and turtles.

I have tremendous respect for her because she's living proof that one individual can make a meaningful difference. She's inspired me and many of my classmates to be more mindful of our environmental footprint.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
passionate about	adj phr	/ˈpæʃ.ən.ət əˈbaʊt/	feeling strongly about	đam mê về
hands-on	adj	/hændz ɒn/	involving active participation	thực hành
sustainability	n	/səˌsteɪ.nəˈbɪl.ə.ti/	ability to maintain without harm	sự bền vững
practise what one preaches	idiom	/ˈpræk.tɪs wɒt wʌn priːtʃɪz/	to do what you advise	làm đúng những gì mình nói
marine pollution	n phr	/məˈriːn pəˈluː.ʃən/	contamination of the ocean	ô nhiễm biển
organic	adj	/ɔːˈɡæɪn.ɪk/	produced without chemicals	hữu cơ
rehabilitate	v	/ˌriː.həˈbɪl.ɪ.teɪt/	to restore to good health	phục hồi
environmental footprint	n phr	/ɪnˌvaɪ.rənˈmen.təl ˈfʊt.prɪnt/	one's impact on nature	dấu chân môi trường
mindful	adj	/ˈmaɪnd.fəl/	being aware and considerate	có ý thức

Part 3 — Discussion Questions

1. Do you think parents should teach their children how to protect the environment?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Absolutely. Environmental awareness should start at home because children tend to model their parents' behaviour. Simple habits like separating waste, saving water, and reducing plastic use can be instilled from an early age. If parents lead by example, their children are far more likely to grow into environmentally responsible adults.

2. What laws about the environment are effective in your country?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

In Vietnam, there have been recent regulations aimed at cutting down on single-use plastics, which have shown promising results. Many supermarkets now charge for plastic bags, and some cities have banned Styrofoam food containers. However, enforcement is still inconsistent. Overall, the legal framework is improving, but there's a long way to go.

3. Is it important to teach students environmental protection at school?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I strongly believe it is. Schools have the unique advantage of reaching a large number of young minds at once. If environmental education is woven into the curriculum through hands-on activities like gardening or nature walks, students will develop a genuine connection with nature rather than seeing conservation as just another textbook topic.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
environmental awareness	n phr	/ɪnˌvaɪ.rən'men.təl ə'weə.nəs/	understanding of ecological issues	nhận thức về môi trường
instil	v	/ɪn'stɪl/	to gradually establish an idea	truyền dạy, thấm nhuần
lead by example	v phr	/li:d baɪ ɪg'zɑ:m.pəl/	to show correct behaviour	làm gương
single-use	adj	/ˌsɪŋ.gəl 'ju:s/	designed to be used once	dùng một lần
enforcement	n	/ɪn'fɔ:s.mənt/	the act of ensuring compliance	sự thực thi
legal framework	n phr	/li:ˌgəl 'freɪm.wɜ:k/	a system of laws and regulations	khung pháp lý
woven into	v phr	/'wʊv.vən 'ɪn.tu:/	integrated naturally	lồng ghép vào
conservation	n	/ˌkɒn.sə'veɪ.jən/	protection of natural resources	bảo tồn

2.3 Describe a short-term job you want to have in a foreign country

IELTS Part 2 — Cue Card

Describe a short-term job you want to have in a foreign country. You should say:

- Where it is
- How you know of it
- What the job is
- And explain why you want to do it.

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

If I had the chance, I'd love to work as a barista at a specialty coffee shop in Melbourne, Australia, for about three to six months. I first learned about this opportunity through a gap-year travel blog on Instagram, and I've been dreaming about it ever since.

Melbourne has this incredible cafe culture that's famous worldwide. The city is packed with independent coffee shops that take their craft really seriously — from hand-poured pour-overs to latte art competitions. As someone who's already obsessed with coffee, working there would be like a masterclass in the art of brewing.

What really appeals to me is not just the work itself, but the whole experience of living abroad. I'd get to practise my English in a native-speaking environment, meet people from different cultural backgrounds, and develop transferable skills like customer service and time management. The main reason I want this job is that it would push me out of my comfort zone and give me a taste of independence before I graduate.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
barista	n	/bə'ri:s.tə/	a person who makes coffee	nhân viên pha cà phê
specialty	adj	/'speʃ.əl.ti/	focusing on a particular high-quality area	chuyên biệt
gap year	n phr	/gæp jɪər/	a year taken off before or after university	năm nghỉ giữa kỳ
craft	n	/kra:ft/	a skilled activity or trade	nghề thủ công, kỹ năng
masterclass	n	/'ma:..stə.kla:s/	an expert-level lesson	khóa học bậc thầy
transferable skills	n phr	/træns'fɜ:.rə.bəl skɪlz/	skills useful in many jobs	kỹ năng có thể chuyển đổi
comfort zone	n phr	/'kʌm.fət zəʊn/	a familiar, easy situation	vùng an toàn
taste of independence	n phr	/teɪst ɒv ,ɪn.dɪ'pen.dəns/	a brief experience of self-reliance	trải nghiệm sự tự lập

Part 3 — Discussion Questions

1. What short-term jobs do young people do in other countries?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

A lot of young people take up jobs in the hospitality sector, like working as hotel receptionists, tour guides, or waiters. Teaching English is another popular option, especially in Asian countries. Some also do farm work through programs like WWOOF, which lets you work on organic farms in exchange for accommodation and meals.

2. What challenges do young people face when working abroad?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

The biggest challenge is probably the language barrier. Even if you speak English well, understanding local slang or accents can be really tricky at first. Cultural differences are another hurdle — things like workplace etiquette and communication styles can vary dramatically. Homesickness is also a real issue for those who've never been away from their families for an extended period.

3. What are the benefits of working for an international company?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

There are numerous advantages. First, you get exposure to diverse perspectives and working styles, which broadens your professional horizons. International companies also tend to offer more competitive salaries and better training programmes. Perhaps most importantly, the cross-cultural communication skills you develop can open doors to career opportunities you might never have imagined.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
hospitality sector	n phr	/ˌhɒs.pɪˈtæl.ə.ti ˈsek.tər/	the industry of hotels and tourism	ngành dịch vụ khách sạn
language barrier	n phr	/ˈlæŋ.gwɪdʒ ˈbær.i.ər/	difficulty communicating in a foreign language	rào cản ngôn ngữ
workplace etiquette	n phr	/ˈwɜːk.pleɪs ˈet.i.ket/	accepted standards of behaviour at work	nghi thức nơi công sở
homesickness	n	/ˈhəʊm.sɪk.nəs/	longing for home while away	nỗi nhớ nhà
diverse perspectives	n phr	/daɪˈvɜːs pəˈspek.tɪvz/	varied viewpoints	quan điểm đa dạng
competitive salary	n phr	/kəmˈpet.ɪ.tɪv ˈsæl.ər.i/	pay that matches or exceeds the market	mức lương cạnh tranh
cross-cultural	adj	/krɒs ˈkʌl.tʃər.əl/	involving different cultures	liên văn hóa
broaden one's horizons	v phr	/ˈbrɔː.dən wʌnz həˈraɪ.zənz/	to expand one's knowledge	mở rộng tầm nhìn

2.4 Describe a time when you gave advice to others

IELTS Part 2 — Cue Card

Describe a time when you gave advice to others. You should say:

- When it was
- To whom you gave the advice
- What the advice was
- And explain why you gave the advice.

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

This actually happened just a few months ago when my best friend, Minh, was stressing out about choosing his university major. He was torn between pursuing computer science, which his parents wanted, and graphic design, which was his true passion.

I could see he was really struggling, so I sat down with him over coffee and shared my perspective. I told him that while it's important to consider his parents' wishes, at the end of the day, he'd be the one spending four years studying the subject. So my advice was to follow his passion but also do thorough research into the career prospects of graphic design — basically to show his parents that it's a viable career path.

I gave him this advice because I had gone through a similar dilemma myself when choosing between business and fine arts. I ended up picking business, which I don't regret, but I've always wished someone had encouraged me to think more carefully about what truly makes me happy.

In the end, Minh decided to major in graphic design, and he's absolutely thriving now. He even landed a freelance gig recently, so I'm really glad I spoke up.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
stress out	phr v	/stres aʊt/	to feel very anxious	căng thẳng
torn between	adj phr	/tɔ:n br'twi:n/	unable to decide between options	phân vân giữa
perspective	n	/pə'spek.tɪv/	a particular way of viewing things	quan điểm, góc nhìn
at the end of the day	idiom	/æt ðə end ɒv ðə deɪ/	ultimately	cuối cùng thì
thorough	adj	/'θʌr.ə/	complete and careful	kỹ lưỡng
viable	adj	/'vaɪ.ə.bəl/	capable of working successfully	khả thi
dilemma	n	/dɪ'lem.ə/	a difficult choice between two options	tình thế tiến thoái lưỡng nan
thrive	v	/θraɪv/	to grow and develop well	phát triển mạnh
speak up	phr v	/spi:k ʌp/	to express one's opinion	lên tiếng

Part 3 — Discussion Questions

1. Should people prepare before giving advice?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Definitely. Good advice requires some thought and perhaps even research beforehand. If you just blurt out whatever comes to mind without considering the other person's situation, your advice might do more harm than good. Taking time to understand the full picture shows genuine care and increases the likelihood that your advice will be helpful.

2. Is it good to ask advice from strangers online?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

It can be useful in certain situations, like getting product recommendations or technical help. However, I'd be cautious about seeking personal or medical advice from strangers because you never know their qualifications or intentions. There's also the risk of misinformation. So it's fine as a starting point, but you should always verify what you read.

3. What are the problems if you ask too many people for advice?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

The main issue is information overload. When you consult too many people, you end up with conflicting opinions, which can make decision-making even more confusing. It can also lead to analysis paralysis — where you spend so much time weighing viewpoints that you never actually make a decision. Sometimes it's better to trust your own judgement.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
blurt out	phr v	/blɜ:t aʊt/	to say something suddenly	buột miệng nói
do more harm than good	idiom	/du: mɔ:r hɑ:m ðæn gʊd/	to cause more damage	gây hại nhiều hơn lợi
likelihood	n	/'laɪ.kli.hʊd/	the chance of something happening	khả năng
misinformation	n	/ˌmɪs.ɪn.fə'meɪ.ʃən/	false or inaccurate information	thông tin sai lệch
verify	v	/'ver.ɪ.fai/	to check if something is true	xác minh
information overload	n phr	/ˌɪn.fə'meɪ.ʃən 'əʊ.və.ləʊd/	too much data to process	quá tải thông tin
conflicting opinions	n phr	/kən'flɪk.tɪŋ ə'pɪn.jənz/	disagreeing views	ý kiến trái ngược
analysis paralysis	n phr	/ə'næl.ə.sɪs pə'ræl.ə.sɪs/	inability to decide due to overthinking	tê liệt vì phân tích quá nhiều

2.5 Describe a person who often helps others

IELTS Part 2 — Cue Card

Describe a person who often helps others. You should say:

- Who this person is
- How this person helps others
- How you know about this person
- And explain why you think this person likes to help others.

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

The person I'd like to describe is my class representative, Huy. He's been in my study group since our freshman year, and he's one of the most selfless people I've ever met. What stands out about Huy is that he goes out of his way to help classmates who are struggling academically. Before every major exam, he organises free tutoring sessions in the library where he explains complex concepts in a really approachable way. He even creates shared Google Drive folders with neatly organised notes and past exam papers.

Beyond academics, Huy is also active in volunteer work. He coordinates blood donation drives on campus and has been mentoring underprivileged high school students on weekends for the past two years.

I think the reason Huy enjoys helping others is that he genuinely finds fulfilment in seeing people succeed. He once told me that growing up in a low-income family taught him the value of community support, and he wants to pay it forward whenever he can.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
selfless	adj	/ˈself.ləs/	putting others' needs first	vị tha
go out of one's way	idiom	/gəʊ aʊt ɒv wʌnz weɪ/	to make extra effort	cố gắng hết sức
approachable	adj	/əˈprəʊ.tʃə.bəl/	friendly and easy to talk to	dễ tiếp cận
blood donation drive	n phr	/blʌd dəʊˈneɪ.ʃən draɪv/	a campaign to collect blood	đợt hiến máu
underprivileged	adj	/ˌʌn.dəˈprɪv.əl.ɪdʒd/	lacking advantages	thiệt thòi
pay it forward	idiom	/peɪ ɪt ˈfɔː.wəd/	to repay kindness by helping others	trả ơn bằng cách giúp người khác
fulfilment	n	/fʊlˈfɪl.mənt/	satisfaction from achieving	sự thỏa mãn
empathy	n	/ˈem.pə.θi/	understanding others' feelings	sự đồng cảm

Part 3 — Discussion Questions

1. What can children do to help their parents?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Children can contribute in many practical ways. Simple tasks like tidying up their rooms, washing the dishes, or helping with grocery shopping can make a significant difference. As they get older, they can take on more responsibility, such as cooking simple meals or looking after younger siblings.

2. Should children help their parents with household chores?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I strongly believe they should. Doing household chores teaches children essential life skills like time management, discipline, and a sense of responsibility. It also helps them understand that maintaining a home is a shared effort. Research shows children who participate in chores tend to become more empathetic and cooperative adults.

3. Why are employees reluctant to ask their managers for help?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I think many employees fear being perceived as incompetent or weak. There's often pressure to appear self-sufficient, especially in competitive work environments. Some also worry that seeking help might negatively affect their performance reviews. However, asking for guidance when needed is actually a sign of self-awareness and professionalism.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
contribute	v	/kən'trɪb.ju:t/	to give something of value	đóng góp
tidy up	phr v	/'taɪ.di ʌp/	to make a place neat	dọn dẹp gọn gàng
take on responsibility	v phr	/teɪk ɒn rɪ'spɒn.sɪ'bɪl.ə.ti/	to accept a duty	đảm nhận trách nhiệm
shared effort	n phr	/ʃeəd 'ef.ət/	work done together	nỗ lực chung
cooperative	adj	/kəʊ'ɒp.ər.ə.tɪv/	willing to work with others	có tinh thần hợp tác
perceived as	v phr	/pə'si:vɪd æz/	seen or regarded as	bị xem là
incompetent	adj	/ɪn'kɒm.pɪ.tənt/	lacking ability	kém năng lực
self-sufficient	adj	/ˌself.sə'fɪʃ.ənt/	able to function independently	tự lực

2.6 Describe one of your friends who learned something without a teacher

IELTS Part 2 — Cue Card

Describe one of your friends who learned something without a teacher. You should say:

- Who this person is
- What he/she learned
- How he/she learned it
- And explain how you felt about it.

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I'd like to talk about my roommate, Tuan, who taught himself how to play the guitar entirely through YouTube tutorials. This was about two years ago, during the pandemic lockdown when we were all stuck at home with lots of free time.

Tuan had always wanted to learn guitar but never had the money for formal lessons. So one day, he bought a second-hand acoustic guitar from an online marketplace and started watching beginner tutorials. The first few weeks were pretty painful to listen to — wrong chords everywhere — but he was incredibly persistent and practised for at least an hour every day.

What impressed me most was his systematic approach. He created a structured learning plan, starting with basic chords, then strumming patterns, and eventually full songs. Within about six months, he could play popular songs really fluently, and now he even writes his own music.

I was genuinely amazed because it showed me that with discipline and the right resources, you can teach yourself almost anything. It actually motivated me to start learning digital illustration on my own.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
teach oneself	v phr	/ti:tʃ wʌn'self/	to learn without instruction	tự học
second-hand	adj	/,sek.ənd'hænd/	previously owned	đã qua sử dụng
persistent	adj	/pə'sis.tənt/	continuing despite difficulties	kiên trì
systematic	adj	/,sɪs.tə'mæt.ɪk/	done in an organised way	có hệ thống
strumming pattern	n phr	/'strʌm.ɪŋ 'pæt.ən/	a rhythmic way of playing guitar	mẫu quạt đàn
fluently	adv	/'flu:.ənt.li/	smoothly and easily	trôi chảy
discipline	n	/'dɪs.ə.plɪn/	self-control and dedication	kỷ luật
amazed	adj	/ə'meɪzd/	greatly surprised	kinh ngạc
motivated	adj	/'məʊ.tɪ.veɪ.tɪd/	enthusiastic to do something	có động lực

Part 3 — Discussion Questions

1. Is it necessary to keep learning after graduating from school?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Absolutely. In today's rapidly evolving world, knowledge from school can become outdated within a few years. Lifelong learning is essential to stay competitive in the job market and adapt to new technologies. Learning doesn't have to be formal — reading books, taking online courses, or learning from colleagues all count.

2. Should teachers make learning in their classes fun?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I think so, within reason. When learning is enjoyable, students are naturally more engaged and retain information better. Interactive activities and real-world examples can make even dry subjects interesting. However, there should be a balance — entertainment shouldn't come at the expense of academic rigour.

3. Do you think it is good for older adults to continue learning?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Without a doubt. Continuing to learn keeps the mind sharp and can reduce the risk of cognitive decline. Many older adults find great joy in learning new skills like painting, a foreign language, or using technology. It also gives them a sense of purpose and helps them stay connected with younger generations.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
rapidly evolving	adj phr	/ˈræp.ɪd.li ɪˈvɒl.v.ɪŋ/	changing quickly	thay đổi nhanh chóng
outdated	adj	/ˌaʊtˈdeɪ.tɪd/	no longer current or useful	lỗi thời
lifelong learning	n phr	/ˌlaɪf.lɒŋ ˈlɜː.nɪŋ/	continuous education throughout life	học tập suốt đời
retain	v	/rɪˈteɪn/	to keep or remember	ghi nhớ
academic rigour	n phr	/ˌæk.əˈdem.ɪk ˈrɪɡ.ər/	strict scholarly standards	sự nghiêm túc học thuật
cognitive decline	n phr	/ˈkɒɡ.nɪ.tɪv dɪˈklaɪn/	gradual loss of mental ability	suy giảm nhận thức
sense of purpose	n phr	/sens əv ˈpɜː.pəs/	feeling of having meaning	cảm giác có mục đích
stay connected	v phr	/steɪ kəˈnek.tɪd/	to maintain relationships	duy trì kết nối

2.7 Describe a piece of technology (not a phone) that you would like to own

IELTS Part 2 — Cue Card

Describe a piece of technology (not a phone) that you would like to own. You should say:

- What it is
- How much it costs
- How you knew it
- And explain why you would like to own it.

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

The piece of technology I've been eyeing is the iPad Pro with the Apple Pencil. It retails for around 25 to 30 million VND, which is a pretty hefty price tag for a student like me.

I first discovered it when a popular Vietnamese YouTuber did a review of it for digital art and note-taking. Since then, I've been doing extensive research through comparison videos and forums.

The main reason I want it is for digital illustration. Right now, I'm using a budget drawing tablet connected to my laptop, which isn't very portable. With an iPad Pro, I could sketch and design anywhere — in a cafe, on the bus, or even during boring lectures. The screen quality is apparently phenomenal for colour-accurate artwork.

On top of that, it would be incredibly useful for university. I could annotate lecture slides, organise my notes digitally, and reduce paper use. It's basically a creative tool and productivity device rolled into one. Owning an iPad Pro would be a real game-changer for both my studies and my freelance work. I'm saving up for one right now.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
retail for	v phr	/ˈriː.təl fɔːr/	to be sold at a certain price	bán lẻ với giá
hefty price tag	n phr	/ˈhef.ti praɪs tæg/	an expensive cost	mức giá đắt đỏ
extensive research	n phr	/ɪkˈsten.sɪv rɪˈsɜːtʃ/	thorough investigation	nghiên cứu kỹ lưỡng
portable	adj	/ˈpɔː.tə.bəl/	easy to carry around	dễ mang theo
phenomenal	adj	/fɪˈnɒm.i.nəl/	remarkably great	phi thường
annotate	v	/ˈæn.ə.teɪt/	to add notes or comments	chú thích
productivity	n	/ˌprɒd.ʌkˈtɪv.ə.ti/	effectiveness of work	năng suất
game-changer	n	/geɪm ˈtʃeɪn.dʒər/	something that alters a situation	bước ngoặt
save up	phr v	/seɪv ʌp/	to accumulate money	tích góp tiền

Part 3 — Discussion Questions

1. What are the differences between the technology of the past and that of today?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

The most obvious difference is the speed of development. In the past, advancements took decades, whereas now they happen in years. Modern technology is also far more integrated into daily life. Another key difference is accessibility — technology used to be a luxury, but today even advanced devices are affordable for most people.

2. What technology do young people like to use?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Young people are heavily drawn to social media platforms like TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube. Beyond entertainment, we rely on productivity tools like Notion and creative apps like Canva. Gaming technology is another huge area. Overall, young people gravitate towards technology that's mobile, connected, and visually engaging.

3. Do you think technology has changed the way people communicate?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Dramatically, yes. Instant messaging and video calling mean we can maintain relationships across vast distances. However, this convenience comes at a cost — digital communication lacks the depth and emotional warmth of face-to-face interaction. There's also the issue of people becoming overly dependent on screens, which can actually make them feel more isolated despite being constantly connected.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
technological advancement	n phr	/ˌtek.nə'lɒdʒ.ɪ.kəl əd'vɑːns.mənt/	progress in technology	tiến bộ công nghệ
integrated	adj	/'ɪn.tɪ.greɪ.tɪd/	combined into a unified whole	tích hợp
accessibility	n	/ək'ses.ə'bɪl.ə.ti/	quality of being available to all	khả năng tiếp cận
gravitate towards	phr v	/'græv.ɪ.tɜrt tə'wɔːdz/	to be drawn to	bị hút về phía
visually engaging	adj phr	/'vɪʒ.u.əl.ɪ ɪn'geɪ.dʒɪŋ/	attractive to look at	thu hút thị giác
instant messaging	n phr	/'ɪn.stənt 'mes.ɪ.dʒɪŋ/	sending real-time text messages	nhắn tin nhanh
emotional warmth	n phr	/'ɪməʊ.ʃən.əl wɔːmθ/	genuine affection	sự ấm áp tình cảm
isolated	adj	/'aɪ.sə.leɪ.tɪd/	feeling alone	cô lập

2.8 Describe a perfect job you would like to have in the future

IELTS Part 2 — Cue Card

Describe a perfect job you would like to have in the future. You should say:

- What it is
- How you knew it
- What you need to learn to get this job
- And explain why you think it is a perfect job for you.

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

My dream job would be to work as a brand strategist at a creative agency. I first became aware of this career path during an internship fair at my university, where a representative from a marketing firm gave a really inspiring presentation about how they help businesses build their identities.

To get this job, I'd need to strengthen several skills. First, a solid understanding of market research and consumer psychology. I'm currently taking elective courses in these areas. Beyond theory, I'd also need strong creative skills — visual storytelling, copywriting, and design principles. My freelance graphic design experience has already given me a head start.

The reason it's a perfect fit for me is that it combines my two main interests: business strategy and creative design. I love the idea of helping a company find its unique voice and communicate it through visuals, campaigns, and storytelling. What excites me most is the opportunity to see the tangible impact of my work — knowing that the branding I create could shape how millions of people perceive a company.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
brand strategist	n phr	/brænd 'stræt.i.dʒɪst/	a person who plans brand identity	chuyên gia chiến lược thương hiệu
creative agency	n phr	/kri'eɪ.tɪv 'eɪ.dʒən.si/	a company specialising in design	công ty sáng tạo
internship fair	n phr	/ˈɪn.tɜːn.ʃɪp feər/	event for finding training positions	hội chợ thực tập
consumer psychology	n phr	/kən'sjuː.mər saɪ'kɒl.ə.dʒi/	study of buyer behaviour	tâm lý người tiêu dùng
head start	n phr	/hed stɑ:t/	an early advantage	lợi thế ban đầu
copywriting	n	/ˈkɒp.i.raɪ.tɪŋ/	writing promotional text	viết quảng cáo
a perfect fit	n phr	/ə 'pɜː.fɪkt fɪt/	ideally suited	sự phù hợp hoàn hảo
tangible impact	n phr	/ˈtæŋ.dʒɪ.bəl 'ɪm.pækt/	a real, noticeable effect	tác động hữu hình
perceive	v	/pə'siːv/	to regard or understand	nhận thức

Part 3 — Discussion Questions

1. What kind of job can be called a 'dream job'?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I think a dream job aligns with your passions and gives you a sense of purpose while providing financial stability. It's not just about earning a high salary — it's about feeling fulfilled and motivated every day. Ideally, it should also offer work-life balance so you have time for personal interests and family.

2. What jobs do children want to do when they grow up?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Children tend to dream of glamorous or heroic jobs. Many want to be doctors, astronauts, firefighters, or pop stars. These days, young children increasingly say they want to be YouTubers or gamers, which reflects how much digital culture has influenced their aspirations. Of course, most children's career ambitions change dramatically as they grow older.

3. Is salary the main reason why people choose a certain job?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

It's a major factor, but not the only one. While everyone needs to earn a living, studies consistently show that job satisfaction, work-life balance, and career growth are equally important. Some individuals willingly accept lower salaries to work in fields they're passionate about, like teaching or social work. So it's more of a balancing act than a single deciding factor.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
align with	phr v	/ə'laɪn wɪð/	to be in agreement with	phù hợp với
sense of purpose	n phr	/sens ɒv 'pʊː.pəs/	feeling of having meaning	cảm giác có mục đích
financial stability	n phr	/fai'næn.jəl stə'bil.ə.ti/	secure income	sự ổn định tài chính
work-life balance	n phr	/wɜːk laɪf 'bæl.əns/	equal priority between work and life	cân bằng cuộc sống - công việc
glamorous	adj	/'glæm.ər.əs/	attractive and exciting	hào nhoáng
aspiration	n	/,æs.prɪ'reɪ.jən/	a strong desire to achieve	khát vọng
job satisfaction	n phr	/dʒɒb ,sæt.ɪs'fæk.jən/	pleasure from one's work	sự hài lòng công việc
balancing act	n phr	/'bæl.ən.sɪŋ ækt/	managing competing priorities	sự cân nhắc

2.9 Describe a child who loves drawing/painting

IELTS Part 2 — Cue Card

Describe a child who loves drawing/painting. You should say:

- Who he/she is
- What he/she likes to draw
- How often he/she draws
- And explain why you think he/she likes drawing.

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I'd like to talk about my little cousin, Nhi, who is seven years old and absolutely obsessed with drawing. Every time I visit my aunt's house, I find Nhi sitting at the kitchen table surrounded by scattered crayons and sketchbooks, completely lost in her own creative world.

She loves drawing animals — especially cats and rabbits — and she has this unique style where all her animals have exaggerated, comically large eyes, which is honestly adorable. She also enjoys drawing scenes from her favourite cartoons and occasionally attempts to sketch family members, though the results are hilariously disproportionate. Nhi draws almost every single day, sometimes for hours on end. Her parents told me she even doodles during meals if they don't keep an eye on her. She recently won a small art competition at her primary school, which absolutely made her day.

I think she loves drawing because it gives her a way to express herself without words. At her age, children often struggle to articulate complex feelings, and art provides a natural outlet. Plus, her parents have always encouraged her creativity by buying her art supplies and praising her work, which has really nurtured her passion.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
obsessed with	adj phr	/əb'sest wið/	extremely interested in	cuồng với
scattered	adj	/'skæt.əd/	spread out in disorder	nằm rải rác
sketchbook	n	/'sketʃ.bʊk/	a book for drawing in	sổ phác họa
exaggerated	adj	/ɪg'zædʒ.ər.eɪ.tɪd/	made larger or extreme	phóng đại
disproportionate	adj	/,dɪs.prə'pɔː.ʃən.ət/	not in correct ratio	không cân đối
make one's day	idiom	/meɪk wʌnz deɪ/	to make someone very happy	làm ai đó vui sướng
articulate	v	/ɑː'tɪk.jə.leɪt/	to express clearly	diễn đạt rõ ràng
outlet	n	/'aʊt.let/	a means of expression	phương tiện bày tỏ
nurture	v	/'nɜː.tʃər/	to care for and encourage growth	nuôi dưỡng

Part 3 — Discussion Questions

1. What is the right age for a child to learn drawing?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

I don't think there's a strict right age. Children naturally start scribbling as early as two or three, and that instinct should be encouraged. Structured art classes can probably begin around five or six when children have developed enough fine motor skills to hold pencils properly and follow basic instructions.

2. Why do most children draw more often than adults do?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Children have fewer responsibilities and more free time. They also tend to be less self-conscious about their abilities — they draw for pure enjoyment without worrying about results. Adults often become overly critical of themselves or simply don't prioritise creative activities because of work and family commitments.

3. How do artworks inspire people?

Sample 1: Student Persona (Band 7-8)

Art has the power to evoke emotions, challenge perspectives, and spark new ideas. A beautiful painting might make someone feel peaceful or nostalgic, while a provocative piece could encourage them to think about social issues differently. For creative professionals, studying great artworks serves as a wellspring of inspiration. In essence, art connects people to deeper truths about the human experience.

Từ	Loại	IPA	English Meaning	Dịch nghĩa
scribble	v	/ˈskrɪb.əl/	to write or draw carelessly	vẽ nguệch ngoạc
fine motor skills	n phr	/faɪn ˈməʊ.tər skɪlz/	precise movements of small muscles	kỹ năng vận động tinh
self-conscious	adj	/ˌself ˈkɒn.jəs/	worried about others' judgement	tự ti
overly critical	adj phr	/ˈəʊ.vəl.i ˈkrɪ.tɪ.kəl/	too judgmental	quá khắt khe
evoke	v	/ɪˈvəʊk/	to bring a feeling to mind	gợi lên
nostalgic	adj	/nəˈstæl.dʒɪk/	feeling longing for the past	hoài niệm
provocative	adj	/prəˈvɒk.ə.tɪv/	deliberately causing thought	khiêu khích, gợi suy nghĩ
wellspring	n	/ˈwel.spɪŋ/	an abundant source	nguồn dồi dào